

RICE

Like corn and wheat, rice is a staple food. It is the main

food of almost half the world's population. As much as 90 percent of the world's rice is grown in Asia. However, the Asian countries eat most of what they grow. The US also produces huge amounts of rice, but sells a lot of what it grows to the rest of the world.

How the rice plant is used

The grain is the part of the plant we eat.

Damaged grains are used to make beer, and flour for cakes and noodles.

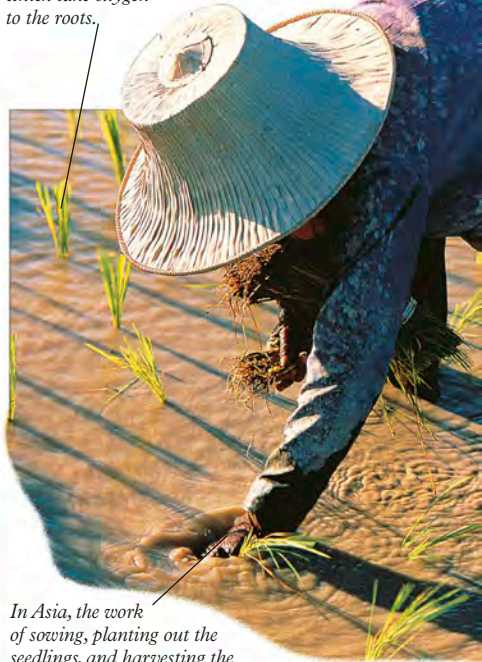
Husks are used as animal feed or to make fertilizer.

Grain

The stems are woven into baskets, mats, and hats.



Rice is a swamp plant. It grows with its roots in water. It has hollow stems which take oxygen to the roots.



In Asia, the work of sowing, planting out the seedlings, and harvesting the rice is usually done by hand.



Preparing the fields

The paddy fields are flooded, plowed, raked, and flattened. In Asia, buffaloes are sometimes still used to do the heavy work.



Planting out

The presprouted seedlings are moved to the paddy fields. They are planted far apart so they have plenty of space to grow.